Pedro Hurtado

PhD(c) in Economics · University of Chile

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Machine Learning, Political Economy, Development Economics, Causal Inference, Program Evaluation.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics *2026 (expected)*
University of Chile

B.A. in Business and Economics *2009*
University of Chile *First in class*

B.A. in Music Interpretation *2013*
Royal Conservatoire of Music of Madrid

WORKING PAPERS

Target Smarter, Not Harder: Efficiency Gains in Micro-entrepreneurship Programs by Using Machine Learning

Applies causal forests and policy learning to a six-country RCT (Banerjee et al., 2015) to show that data-driven targeting can improve welfare gains up to 6.7× relative to random allocation.

Constitutional Content and Economic Growth

Uses a balanced panel of 57 countries (1961–2018) to estimate how specific constitutional provisions—central bank authority, free-competition guarantees, and property-rights protections—affect long-run GDP per capita growth at different time horizons.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Use of Machine Learning Tools for Social Program Evaluation *Thesis Paper*
Employing advanced ML techniques to evaluate and optimize social programs in development economies.

Does a New Constitution Cause Growth? *Thesis Paper*
A machine learning-based analysis of the economic impact of constitutional changes.

Micro-entrepreneurship Program Effectiveness – Impact assessment of micro-entrepreneurship initiatives using ML techniques.

Economic Policy Analysis – Studies on SDR Allocation Mechanisms and Innovative Financing Instruments at ECLAC, United Nations.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant *Oct 2023 – Present*
National Fund for Research and Development, Prof. Jaime Ruiz-Tagle

Consultant *Oct 2021 – Jul 2022*
United Nations, ECLAC

Research Assistant *Feb 2021 – May 2021*
Prof. Ricardo Ffrench-Davis (National Award in Social Sciences)

Research Manager *Sep 2019 – Present*
University of Chile, Faculty of Economics and Business

TEACHING

Microeconomics for Public Policy · Master in Public Policy, Universidad de Chile *2022, 2023, 2024*
Inequality, Poverty and Social Policy · Master in Public Policy, Universidad de Chile *2022–2023*

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Full Scholarship for PhD – National Research and Development Agency of Chile (ANID) *2020*
First Ranking of Promotion – B.A. Business and Economics, University of Chile *2009*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: R, Python, Matlab, Stata, LaTeX
Languages: Spanish (Native), English (Fluent)